# RHF: Scaling Global Awareness of Disability for the Future



Vision Consulting

Rick Hansen Foundation

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Question** | How can Rick Hansen Foundation (RHF) adapt, scale, and implement its youth programs and partnerships beyond Canada to increase RHF's worldwide impact? | | |
| **Solution** | **Raise**<br>Raise awareness through a Youth Ideation Challenge | **Harness**<br>Harness local partnerships to scale awareness | **Familiarize**<br>Familiarize RHF name with social media campaigns |
| **KPIs** | **182**<br>Unique ideas generated | **80+**<br>Partnerships reached | **1,022**<br>Active student participation |

# **Overview |** RHF needs to develop a strategy that addresses their goals of expanding into a new location, and developing new youth leaders internationally

## RHF's Current Situation

The RHF is widely recognized as one of Canada's leading organizations advancing accessibility and disability inclusion[1]

The RHF is looking to expand globally[2]

RHF must develop a strategy to replicate its Canadian success globally.

## Goals

1. **Expand** into a new location that fits RHF's core competencies
2. **Develop** new youth leaders internationally, and address the aided vs unaided awareness gap

## Core Competencies



Established in Canda



Existing Education Curriculum



Global Brand Legacy

*Sources: [1]Charity Intelligence Canada, [2]Case*

# **Overview |** The RHF should target high schoolers from ages 13 – 18 due to their accessibility, engagement, and their ability to impact the future

## Who is your target audience



**High Schoolers from ages 13-18**

### Accessible

63% of U.S. K-12 schools provide community service opportunities for students[2]

### Engaged

46% of U.S. youth ages 14–17 participate in community service or volunteer work each year[1]

### The Youth Lead The Future

Investing in youth leaders today creates long-term advocates for accessibility.

## What would an international leadership network of young disability advocates look like



**Advocates**



**Innovators**



**Mentors**

An international Youth Leadership Network would involve empowered students who **advocate, mentor**, and work together to advance accessibility

Sources: 1. KidsCountDataCenter, 2. Youth Service America

# **Overview |** The RHF should launch its youth outreach initiatives in the U.S due to language, cost, partnership, and content delivery considerations

**What location should the RHF launch its youth outreach initiatives first?**



## United States

### Key Considerations



**Language Barriers**

92% of the U.S. population **speaks English proficiently**[1]



**Cost Considerations**

RHF already **has a presence in the U.S,** savings costs in laying the groundwork[2]



**Significance of Disabilities and Partnerships**

**1 in 4** adults live with a disability in the US[3]

Multiple youth engagement organizations that exist across **all 50 states exist in the U.S**[4]



**Delivery of Content Towards Youth**

46% of students are **engaged in service work**, and about **90% of teens are on social media**[5]

*Sources: [1]U.S Census Bureau, [2]Case, [3]CDC [4]DECA, [5]Pew research center*

# **Overview |** RHF's strategy should focus on potential reach, action conversion rate, cost efficiency, and implementation feasibility

| **Strategies Considered** | Potential Reach | Action Conversion Rate | Cost Efficiency | Implementation Feasibility |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Accessibility Ideation Challenge | 🟡 | 🟢 | 🟢 | 🟢 |
| Social Media Stunt | 🟢 | 🔴 | 🟡 | 🔴 |
| Disability Awareness Week in Schools | 🟢 | 🔴 | 🟡 | 🔴 |
| Partnering with Hospitals and programs that require volunteer hours | 🟡 | 🔴 | 🟢 | 🟡 |

*Sources: [1]Case, Verified Market Research, [3]Arc Group [4]PM World Journal*

# **Overview |** RHF should pursue an accessibility ideation challenge to target their key goals

| **Strategies Considered** | Potential Reach | Action Conversion Rate | Cost Efficiency | Implementation Feasibility |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Accessibility Ideation Challenge |  |  |  |  |
| Social Media Stunt |  |  |  |  |
| Disability Awareness Week in Schools |  |  |  |  |
| Partnering with Hospitals and programs that require volunteer hours |  |  |  |  |

*Sources: [1]Case, Verified Market Research, [3]Arc Group [4]PM World Journal*

# Overview | Ideation challenges have high conversion, low cost, and high engagement

| Strategies Considered | Potential Reach | Action Conversion Rate | Cost Efficiency | Implementation Feasibility |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Accessibility Ideation Challenge | ● | ● | ● | ● |



**High Conversion**

Certain Competitions show that up to 33% of students who register for challenges like hackathons go on to building a project[1]



**Low Cost**

Online competitions have low costs mainly revolve around prizes, platform software, and marketing



**High Engagement**

Tens of thousands of students engage in ideation challenges and competitions each year

*Sources: [1]DevPost*

01

## RAISE

Raise awareness through a Youth Ideation Challenge



02

## HARNESS

Harness local partnerships to scale awareness

03

## FAMILIARIZE

Familiarize RHF name with social media campaigns

# Raise | RHF should launch a global youth accessibility ideation challenge as the core program to engage international youth through one scalable platform

## Global Youth Accessibility Ideation Challenge



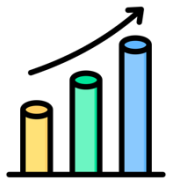

### 1 Youth Engagement through Ideation

Global, 2-month, team-based ideation challenge for youth 13–18



### 2 Direct Mentorship

1-on-1 engagement with RHF team and Youth Leadership Committee mentors



### 3 Online, Scalable Structure

Online first round with community judges, with winners advancing to the World Summit

## World Summit

### 1 Interactive Platform

3-Day Online Forum where winning teams pitch, interact, and network

### 2 Youth Leadership Committee Pipeline

Exclusive feedback from RHF judging committee and individuals with disabilities

### 3 Youth Leadership Committee Pipeline

Successful teams may be considered to join the Youth Leadership Committee

# **Raise** | Piloting the challenge in SoCal will validate participant demand, refine execution, and establish proof of concept before expansion

## Why Southern California




LA28 Paralympics Momentum

2.04M aged 13-18 population[1]

Strong existing youth networks

## Pilot Program Rollout

1. Team of 3-5 Sign Up
2. Bi-Weekly Check-Ins with Mentors
3. Submit 5-Min Pitch to Preliminary Round
4. Winners go to World Summit

## 2027 Ideation Question

How can we improve accessibility in SoCal schools for students with physical disabilities?

Through the SoCal pilot, RHF can identify new Youth Leadership Committee individuals to aid future US expansion and ideate relevant innovative solutions.

*Sources: [1]Kidsdata*

# **Raise** | RHF will attract youth ages 13-18 by offering mentorship, leadership development, recognition, and the opportunity to solve real accessibility issues

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## Why would students join?



**Create real impact** by solving accessibility issues they see in their schools and communities



**Build skills and leadership** through mentorship, teamwork, and problem-solving



Gain **recognition** via the World Summit and and a **pathway** into RHF's Youth Leadership Network

## Benefits for RHF

1. **Increase awareness** by turning passive audiences into active participants
2. **Surface region-specific insights** that help RHF understand new markets
3. **Build a scalable leadership pipeline** by identifying future ambassadors and mentors
4. Introduce relevant issues to younger generations to **close current generational gap**

## Case Study: Technovation Girls

TECHNOVATION Girls

Technovation Girls is a non-profit empowering girls with technology education via an **annual challenge started in 2010** where all-girl teams ideate and pitch mobile applications with the help of community mentors and local chapters

32,000 girls registered and 3,100+ tech-based solutions submitted in 2025

*Sources: [1]Technovation*

# **Raise |** The challenge can be expanded internationally by standardizing the core model while adapting problem statements and partnerships to each local market

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## Pilot



Pilot the Ideation Challenge in Southern California starting in 2027

## Scale



Scale across the US, creating different challenge questions that are relevant to each region

## Expand



Expand globally to allow participants of other countries to join the challenge

Rather than building separate programs to target region-specific disability concerns, RHF can use one globally scalable challenge model to surface local accessibility issues, grow youth advocates, and identify future leaders

01

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Raise awareness through a Youth Ideation Challenge

02

## HARNESS

Harness local partnerships to scale awareness



03

## FAMILIARIZE

Familiarize RHF name with social media campaigns

# **Harness** | Partnering with Rotary taps existing global youth service clubs, embedding accessibility leadership into trusted structures

**Strategic Objective** Engage with passionate youth while leveraging local knowledge

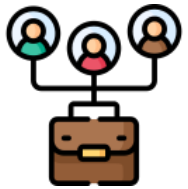
Rotary is a global service organization with **~24,000 youth clubs reaching ~470,000 people worldwide**, each required to run at least 2 community service projects annually.

## Partnership Mechanism

RHF designs a 4-week training packet



Rotary pays C$342 per chapter per year



Promoted as Rotary service project



## Strategic Advantages of Rotary

1. **Massive, Structured Youth Reach**
   Interact (12-18 y/o) and Rotaract (18-30 y/o) cover the target age band with established communities



2. **Self-Supporting Club**
   Rotary's self-supporting clubs implement projects locally, keeping overall costs under C$12k budget



3. **Build Top-of-mind Awareness**
   Repeated exposure as the name appears in club meetings, materials year after year



*Sources: [1]Rotary*

# **Harness** | Partnering with Rotary taps existing global youth service clubs, embedding accessibility leadership into trusted structures

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**Strategic Objective** Engage with passionate youth while leveraging local knowledge

## Key Gaps Rotary Needs Filled



### Fragmentation

Rotary's disability work today is fragmented with a lack of expertise



### Narrow Focus within Accessibility

Existing partnerships focus on employment for people with disabilities, not ideation around everyday accessibility barriers



### Dedicated Partners

Lacks a dedicated global youth partner with RHF's expertise in inclusion

## What RHF Brings to Rotary



### Expertise on Complex Issue

Accessibility and disability inclusion education training for members and educators



### Youth-Relevant Equity Issue

Modern, compelling, and relevant causes and challenges regarding accessibility and inclusion



### Service Project Packaging

Seeks credible NGO partners that provide ready-to-use tools

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# **Familiarize** | Boosting unaided awareness through a unique and funny social media challenge anchored in Summer Paralympics

**Strategic Objective** Build unaided awareness through humorous challenge on social media

## #OneShotChallenge

I'm doing the #OneShotChallenge to spread awareness about accessibility with the Rick Hansen Foundation. This is my one shot.

Take a singular shot of a sport with everyday objects (e.g. throwing a paper ball into the trash bin)

I challenge Bob, Tina, and Mike to send the message forward.

## Challenge Features

**Timing for Virality**
2028 Summer Paralympics to anchor the challenge

**Building a Network**
Challenge friends through tags on social media

**Established Script to Prevent Dilution**
Mention the organization and the purpose

## Case Study



**Ice Bucket Challenge**
Over 17 million people worldwide engaged and over C$20mn raised ALS research

*Sources: [1]ALS*



03

# IMPACT

Key metrics for success, cost and revenue projections, and next steps to implementation

# Impact | To track the success of the strategy, these KPIs should be measured

## ROI



**1.04x**

By Y5

## Educated Students



**1022**

Students who value disability awareness by Y5

## Unique Ideas



**182**

Actionable ideas generated by Y5

## Social Media Reach



**900M**

Impressions per month

## Partnerships

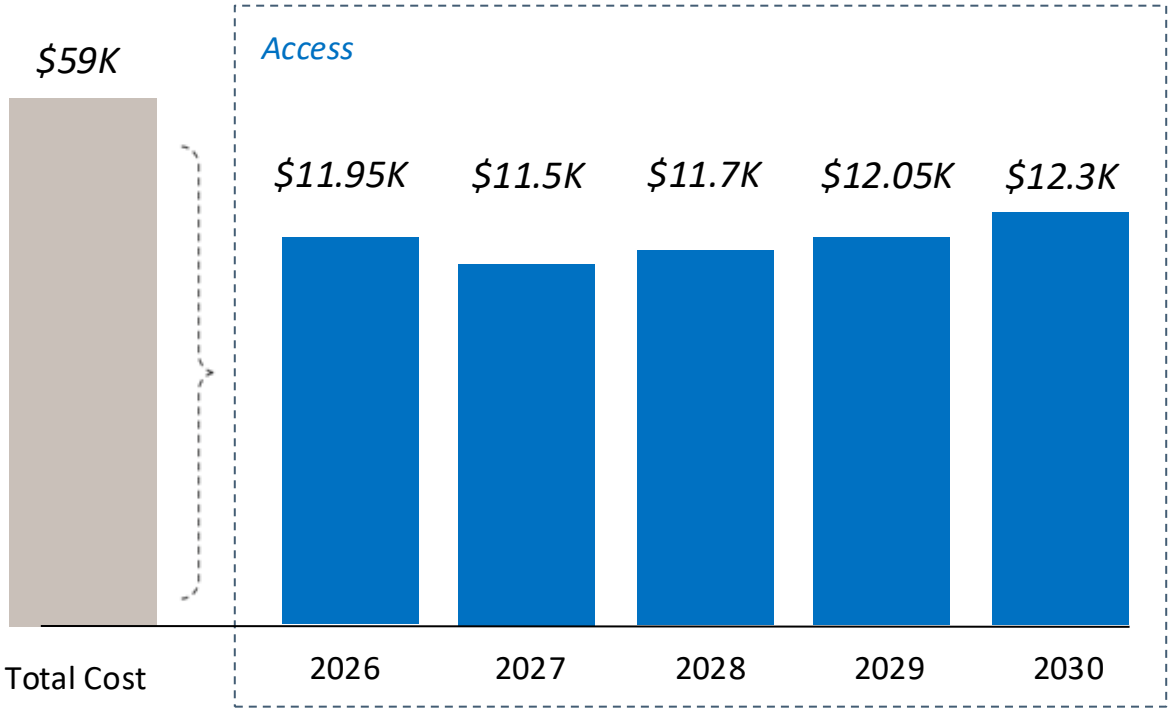


**80+**

Organizations in the US by Y5

# **Impact |** Through this strategy, RHF should expend $12000 CAD annually

## Projects Costs ($ Thousands)




**$10K** Online Platform One Time Build Costs

**~15%** Social Media Marketing

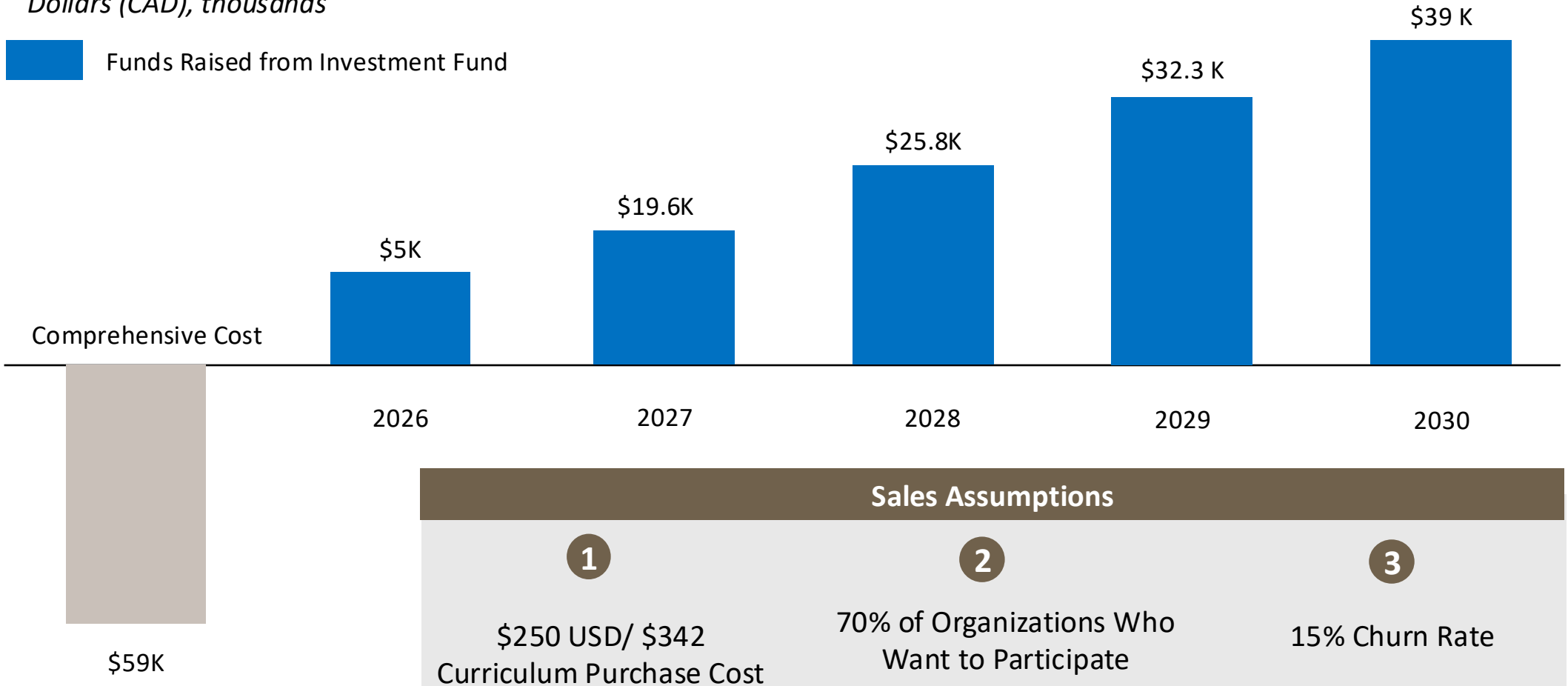
## Cost Drivers

- Partnership Set Up
- Online Competition Program
- Social Media Marketing

# **Impact |** With this strategy, RHF will generate cumulative revenues of 122K

**Revenues Generated**

*Dollars (CAD), thousands*

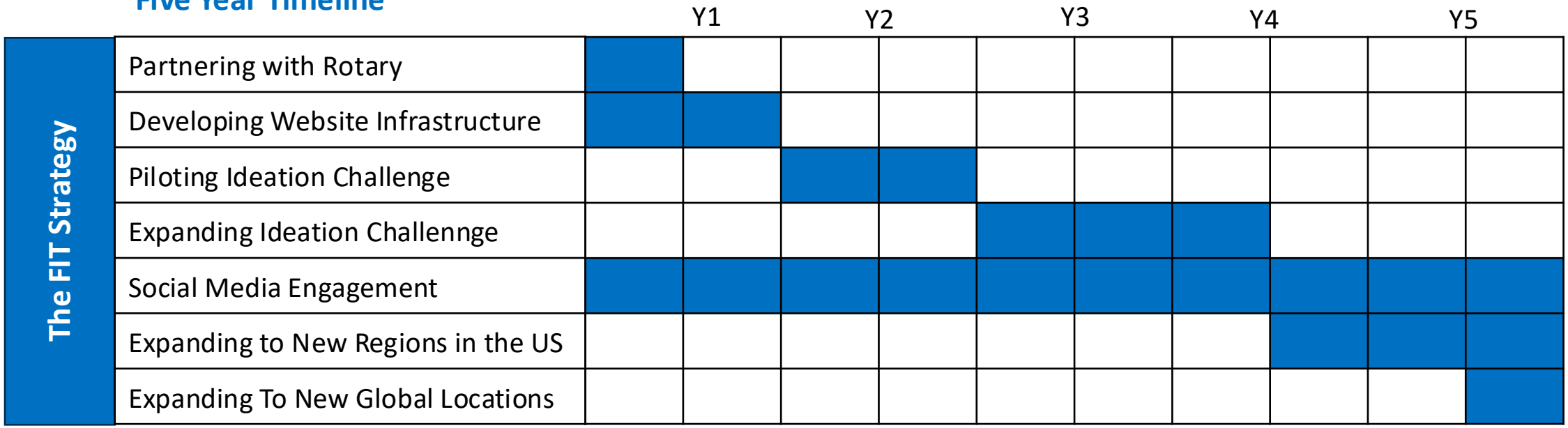



**Sales Assumptions**

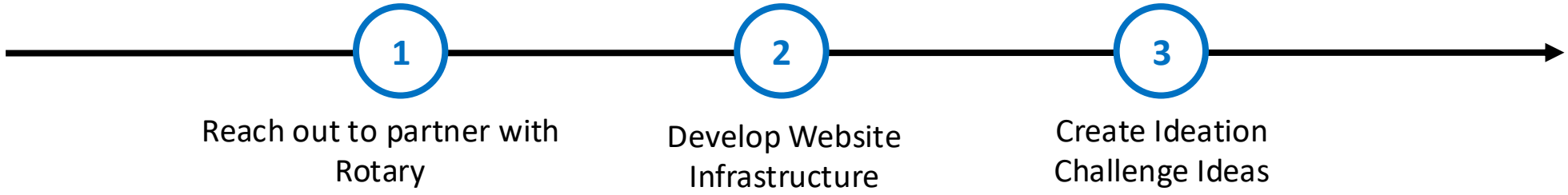
1. $250 USD/ $342 Curriculum Purchase Cost
2. 70% of Organizations Who Want to Participate
3. 15% Churn Rate

# Impact | RHF should ensure these activities are met during their 5Y timeline

## Five Year Timeline

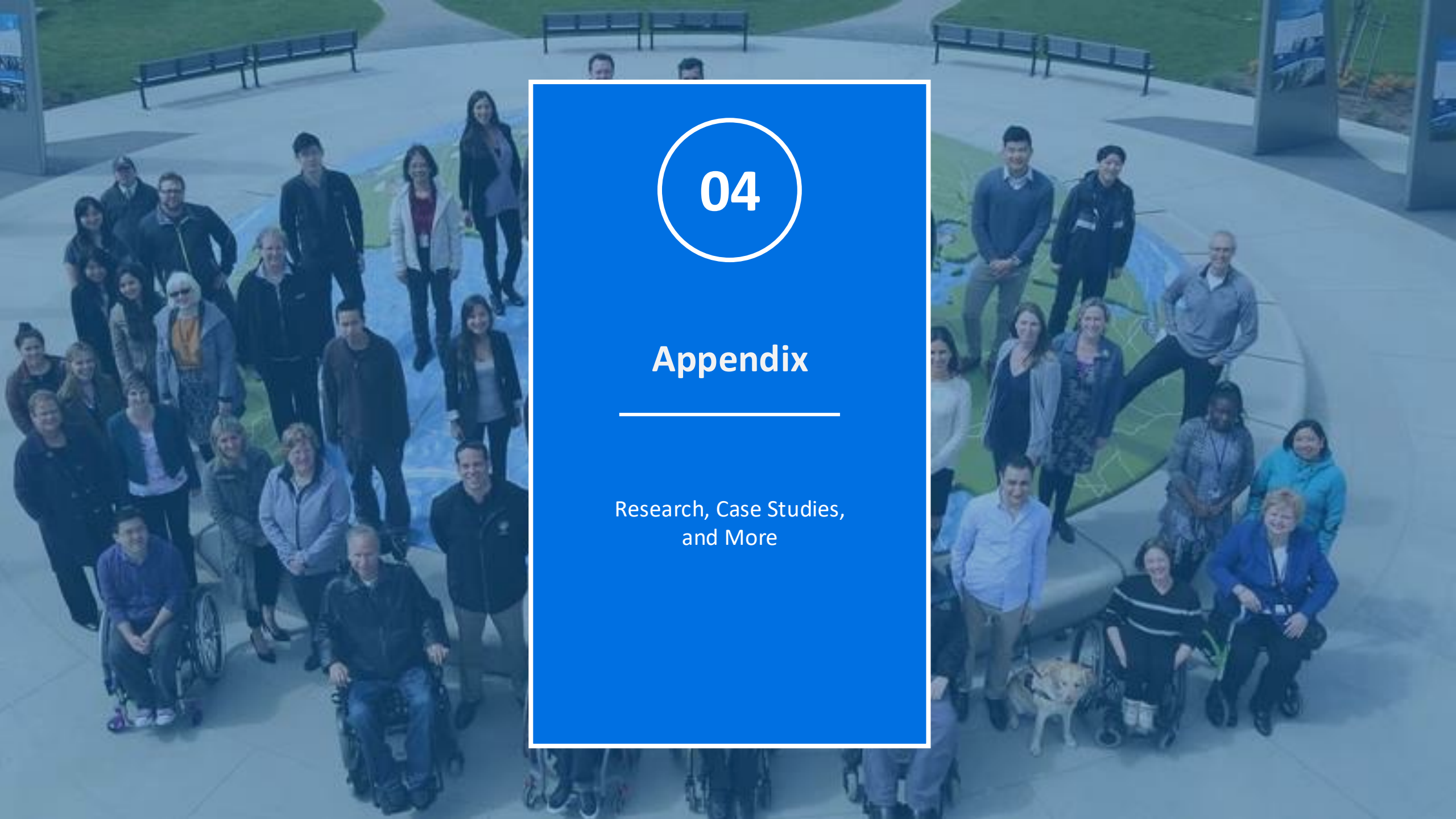



## Immediate Next Steps



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|---|---|---|---|
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| **Solution** | **Raise**<br>Raise awareness through a Youth Ideation Challenge | **Harness**<br>Harness local partnerships to scale awareness | **Familiarize**<br>Familiarize RHF name with social media campaigns |
| **KPIs** | **182**<br>Unique ideas generated | **80+**<br>Partnerships reached | **1,022**<br>Active student participation |



# 04

# Appendix

Research, Case Studies, and More

# Revenue Projections

| Rotary Expansion | 2026 | 2027 | 2028 | 2029 | 2030 | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Target Organiizations | | 50 | 70 | 91 | 113.75 | |
| Organizations Purchasing Curriculum | | 35 | 49 | 63.7 | 79.625 | |
| Total Fees Potentially Collected | | 11970 | 16758 | 21785.4 | 27231.75 | |
| Total Fees Collected after Churn (15%) | | 10174.5 | 14244.3 | 18517.59 | 23146.988 | |
| Donations | | 3937.5 | 5512.5 | 7166.25 | 8957.8125 | |
| Sponsorships | 5000 | 5500 | 6050 | 6655 | 7320.5 | |
| Total | 5000 | 19612 | 25806.8 | 32338.84 | 39425.3 | |
| | | | | | Cumulative | 122182.94 |

# Cost Projections

| Costs | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | 2026 | 2027 | 2028 | 2029 | 2030 |
| **Virtual Ideation Program (Regional)** | | | | | | |
| Competition Hosting Platform One Time Build | | 10000 | | | | |
| Competition Hosting Maintenance | | | 3000 | 3071.4 | 3144.4993 | 3219.3384 |
| Judge Stipends | | | 1000 | 1023.8 | 1048.1664 | 1073.1128 |
| Admin/Staff Coordination | | | 1500 | 1535.7 | 1572.2497 | 1609.6692 |
| Partnership Set Up Costs | | 500 | 511.9 | 524.08322 | 536.5564 | 549.32644 |
| Total | | 10500 | 6011.9 | 6154.9832 | 6301.4718 | 6451.4468 |
| | | | | | | |
| **Virtual Ideation Program (National)** | | | | | | |
| Competition Hosting maintenance | | | 1500 | 1535.7 | 1572.2497 | 1609.6692 |
| Judge Stipends | | | 1000 | 1023.8 | 1048.1664 | 1073.1128 |
| Admin/Staff Coordination | | | 1500 | 1535.7 | 1572.2497 | 1609.6692 |
| Total | | 0 | 4000 | 4095.2 | 4192.6658 | 4292.4512 |
| | | | | | | |
| **Social Media and Marketing** | | | | | | |
| Paid Ads - Competition Awareness | | 500 | 511.9 | 524.08322 | 536.5564 | 549.32644 |
| Paid Ads - General RHF Brand Awareness | | 600 | 614.28 | 628.89986 | 643.86768 | 659.19173 |
| Content Creation & Design | | 100 | 102.38 | 104.81664 | 107.31128 | 109.86529 |
| R&D for Challenges | | 250 | 255.95 | 262.04161 | 268.2782 | 274.66322 |
| Total | | 1450 | 1484.51 | 1519.8413 | 1556.0136 | 1593.0467 |
| | | | | | | |
| Total | | 11950 | 11496.41 | 11770.025 | 12050.151 | 12336.945 |
| | | | | | | 59603.53 |

# KPI Calculations and Profit Analysis

| Number of People Impacted | 2026 | 2027 | 2028 | 2029 | 2030 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Total Participating Organizations | | 35 | 49 | 63.7 | 79.625 |
| Number of Teams | | 175 | 245 | 318.5 | 398.125 |
| Number of Students | | 525 | 735 | 955.5 | 1194.375 |
| % that actually value impact (30%) | | 157.5 | 220.5 | 286.65 | 358.3125 |
| | | | | | 1022.9625 |
| Number of Unique Ideas Created | | | | | |
| Number of Teams | | 175 | 245 | 318.5 | 398.125 |
| Case Submissions Generated(80%) | | 140 | 196 | 254.8 | 318.5 |
| Total Unique Ideas/Actionable (20%) | | 28 | 39.2 | 50.96 | 63.7 |
| | | | | | 181.86 |
| | | | | | |
| Social Media Reach | | | | | |
| US Population | 330000000.00 | | | | |
| Social Media Users | 231000000 | | | | |
| | | | | | |
| Audience Interested in Disability Awareness (30%) | 69300000 | | | | |
| Frequency (10 per month) | 693000000 | | | | |
| Amplication Factor (1.3) | 900900000 | | | | |
| | 900M impressions per month | | | | |

| | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Revenues | | 5000 | 19612 | 25806.8 | 32338.84 | 39425.3 |
| Costs | | 11950 | 11496.41 | 11770.025 | 12050.151 | 12336.945 |
| Profit | | -6950 | 8115.59 | 14036.775 | 20288.689 | 27088.355 |

| | |
|---|---|
| ROI | 1.0499279 |
| Total Rev | 122182.94 |
| Total Costs | 59603.53 |

# Partnership Evaluation

| Dimension | Rotary (Interact + Rotaract) | Scouts / Guides | DECA | Technovation Girls |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Core focus | Service, leadership, community impact for youth and young adults | Character, outdoor skills, citizenship, community service | Business, marketing, entrepreneurship & leadership for students.collegeadvisor+1 | Girls' tech entrepreneurship (build apps/AI solutions to social problems).unesco+2 |
| Primary age range | Interact: 12–18; Rotaract: 18–30. | Mainly 5–18, some young-adult leadership roles | High school and college students (roughly 14–22).collegeadvisor+1 | Girls up to ~18 (middle/high school).unesco+1 |
| Scale / membership | ~340,000 members in ~145 countries; ≈9,500 Rotaract clubs with ~132,000 members globally. | ≈51.4M registered members (2023), ~60M people reached; 176 national Scout organizations.treehouse.scout+2 | 300,000+ members in HS and collegiate chapters across US, Canada, and abroad.wikipedia+1 | 100,000–160,000+ girls reached historically in 120–160+ countries.digitalx.undp+1 |
| Growth trend | Rotary adding new clubs; youth arms are a growth focus. Zone 8 (Aus/NZ/Pacific) exceeded new-club targets and reduced terminations in 2024–25.facebook | World Scouting membership grew 14.2% in latest census and reached historic highs; strong growth in Africa and Asia-Pacific.treehouse.scout+1 | Recent years described as highest membership in DECA's history, indicating current growth.deca | Targeting major scale-up: goal of 100k participants per year by 2024 and 1M annually by 2030.digitalx.undp |
| Global footprint | 200+ countries and territories; Interact/Rotaract present in most regions where Rotary exists.r otary | 176 national organizations across all world regions.scout+2 | Strongest in North America, with some international expansion.wikipedia+1 | Global, but primarily where there is good STEM/tech access and partner support.unesco+2 |
| Program structure | Local clubs meet regularly, run at least one local and one international service project per year.rotary | Local packs/troops with recurring meetings, badges, and service/outdoor activities.scoutconference+1 | Chapters focus on competitive events, conferences, and business projects aligned to DECA's career clusters.collegeadvisor+2 | Yearly challenge cycles: teams build tech solutions and pitch; heavy project-based curriculum.unesco+2 |
| Alignment with accessibility | Strong: service and inclusion focus, plus existing Rotary Employment Partnership for people with intellectual disabilities. rotary | Growing emphasis on inclusion, but culture centred on outdoors/skills more than disability as a social issue. scoutconference+1 | Good fit for "Accessibility x business/marketing" tracks, but core brand is careers, not social impact per se.collegeadvisor+1 | Excellent for "Accessibility x Tech/AI" but limited to girls in tech; narrower than RHF's 13–30 broad youth population.unesco+2 |
| Fit with RHF age 13–30 | Very strong: Interact covers teens; Rotaract directly targets 18–30 (core segment).rotary+2 | Strong for <18, weaker for 18–30 (fewer structured roles).wikipedia+2 | Strong for 14–22 while in school; weaker for out-of-school 18–30.collegeadvisor+2 | Good for girls up to 18; does not cover older youth and is gender/tech-specific.unesco+1 |
| Feasibility of collaboration | High: clear channels for global/district-level partnerships; clubs need annual service projects, so a plug-in accessibility project is low-friction.rotary+1 | Medium: huge scale but program changes (new badges) need central approvals; targeting 18–30 would require custom pathways.scoutconference+2 | Medium: great to sponsor specific challenges or case tracks, but harder to turn into a year-round service network for RHF.collegeadvisor+2 | Medium–low as single anchor; strong as a niche partner for tech-oriented girls, not for a general youth leadership network.unesco+2 |
| Brand / mission compatibility | High: "Service Above Self," leadership, and community improvement maps directly to RHF's accessibility and inclusion mission.rotary+3 | Medium–high: strong on youth development and service, but less explicitly about social/rights-based disability advocacy.scoutconference+1 | Medium: focus on careers and business; accessibility would be one applied topic among many rather than the core theme.collegeadvisor+1 | Medium: strong overlap on using tech for social good, but constrained by gender/tech focus vs RHF's broader disability and accessibility lens.unesco+1 |

# Existing Partnerships

## Partnerships

When you partner with Rotary, our 1.4 million members amplify your impact, elevate your brand, advance important causes, improve communities, and gain access to global connections.



**Polio**

Rotary is a leading partner in the Global Polio Eradication Initiative. With help from our partners, the Gates Foundation, the World Health Organization, the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, UNICEF, and Gavi, the Vaccine Alliance, we've made the world 99.9 percent polio-free.

Learn more ›



**Disaster relief**

Rotary and ShelterBox collaborate to provide emergency shelter and vital supplies to stabilize, protect, and support communities affected by **disasters** and humanitarian crises.

Learn more ›



**Clean water, sanitation, and hygiene**

**Rotary partners with the U.S. Agency for International Development** to assist countries in providing safely managed water, sanitation and hygiene services, while sustainably managing water resources.

Rotary also works with UNICEF to provide technical guidance in the development and implementation of our **WASH in Schools Target Challenge**.

Learn more ›

**Appendix**